

Importance of Acquaintanceships (weak ties): Their role in people's web of relationships and their formation

In contemporary society, most people develop acquaintanceships or weak ties with many others over a lifetime.

Acquaintances represent a diverse group of ties and are situated in the outer layers of one's social network.

They can offer benefits both similar to and different from those offered by close others. They influence close relationships and sometimes develop into close relationships. Drawing from several disciplines (e.g., Social Psychology, Sociology, Communication, and Family Studies), this review article summarizes diverse topics about the role of acquaintances and how acquaintanceships are formed.

The terms acquaintances and weak ties are used interchangeably in this article to refer to the type of relationship that exists in the peripheral layers of social networks.

the importance of acquaintances, which have been identified as more valuable to us than our closest friends, our “weak ties” are for more important to our lives and success than our closest friends or our “strong ties.”

weak ties act as connectors to other social groups. Each of us have our own set of close friends that make up a densely knit clump. These densely knit clumps or strong ties are critical for our social well being, however stunt the flow of information and confines us to the information within these close knit groups.

Weak ties dictate our success by allowing access to the densely knit clumps of our acquaintances. This access to other densely knit groups allows information to flow. Weak ties are absolutely critical to access. The lack of weak ties deprives us of valuable information. Social Networks are creating a weak tie economy, where those with the most and strongest weak ties are the affluent and those with the least and weakest are the poor.

weak ties are critical to getting work, organizing, and access to information.

Those who are unwilling or unable to establish, and leverage weak ties will struggle to survive in this new social economy.

We have relied on weak ties long before the internet and social networks. Our offline weak-ties have always been apart of our personal and social status. We’ ve used them to

find jobs, to find help: like baby sitters, and handymen. We use them for information such as places to stay when we travel. Weak ties introduce us to books and movies and provide random, unexpected information we are unable to get from our close knit friends or strong ties.

ocial Networks allow us to grow our weak ties exponentially, to thousands and tens of thousands online. Social Networks also increase the velocity of our weak ties by getting us access and information in seconds.

